

HANQI WANG

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of British Columbia	2021 – May 2027 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, University of British Columbia	2021
B.M.O.S. (Honors), Accounting and Economics, Western University	2020

Fields

Primary	Econometric Theory
Secondary	Applied Econometrics; Microeconomic Theory

Job Market Paper

Estimating a Rational Inattention Discrete Choice Model: A Semiparametric Approach

Abstract. People's choices depend both on the payoffs of the available options and on what they learn about those payoffs before deciding. This paper develops methods to distinguish unobserved payoff heterogeneity from costly information acquisition in a rational inattention discrete choice model using aggregate choice data. Under Shannon information costs, I establish semiparametric point identification using exogenous utility and information-cost shifters, leaving the taste shock distribution and the information-cost function nonparametric. Environments in which information costs approach zero supply the full-information benchmark that identification relies on. I extend identification to multiple alternatives, establish consistency of a sieve minimum-distance estimator, and construct confidence regions by test inversion that remain valid when estimates lie on the parameter boundary. An application to Amazon Mechanical Turk illustrates the implications of information costs for workers' responses to wages.

References

Kyungchul Song (<i>co-advisor</i>) Professor of Economics Vancouver School of Economics University of British Columbia kyungchul.song@ubc.ca	Paul Schrimpf (<i>co-advisor</i>) Associate Professor of Economics Vancouver School of Economics University of British Columbia paul.schrimpf@ubc.ca	Vitor Farinha Luz Associate Professor of Economics Vancouver School of Economics University of British Columbia vitor.farinhaluz@ubc.ca
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Fellowships and Awards

Four Year Doctoral Fellowship (4YF), University of British Columbia	2022 – 2026
Board of Directors' Gold Medal, highest final-year average in the B.M.O.S. Honors program	2020
Dean's Honor List, Western University	2016 – 2019

Work in Progress

Directed Search with Rational Inattention

Abstract. This paper studies directed search when workers must acquire costly information about wages before deciding where to apply. Workers observe firm types but not realized wages and acquire information at a Shannon entropy cost. We define a rationally inattentive search equilibrium in which application choices determine congestion across submarkets, while congestion shapes job-finding probabilities and the returns to information. We first establish equilibrium existence when the wage distribution has finite support and job-finding probabilities depend continuously on workers' application probabilities. The existence proof allows workers to have multiple optimal information-acquisition strategies. It exploits the fact that linear-fractional maps preserve convexity, together with workers' optimality conditions, to apply Kakutani's fixed-point theorem. We then establish closed-form identification of worker-type-specific information costs using twin job types with identical amenity values but different wages. Given known matching technology, conditional and ex-ante choice shares identify information costs when the twins offer equal job-finding probabilities or their common amenity value is zero, subject to positive shares and a nonzero identifying contrast. Identification relates the twins' difference in expected wage income to the difference between their conditional and ex-ante log choice odds. Together, these results provide an equilibrium foundation and an empirical strategy for measuring attention costs in job search.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting, Emory University	June 2026
Canadian Economics Association Annual Conference, Simon Fraser University	May 2026

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Vancouver School of Economics, UBC

ECON 325	Introduction to Econometrics I	Summer 2026
ECON 425	Advanced Econometrics	Fall 2022, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
ECON 327	Introduction to Empirical Methods	Fall 2023
ECON 301	Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis I	Spring 2023
ECON 102	Principles of Macroeconomics	Spring 2021
ECON 334	Economic History of Modern Europe	Fall 2020

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Professor Kyungchul Song, UBC	Sept 2024 – May 2025
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Professional Service

Referee for <i>Journal of Econometric Methods</i>	2026
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Skills and Languages

Programming	Julia (structural estimation), Python, R, Stata, SQL
Languages	English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Citizenship	People's Republic of China